

PARTNER ENABLEMENT · APRIL 2026

Quick Guide to GitHub Copilot CLI

Your AI-powered terminal assistant for Microsoft 365 licensing, compliance, and beyond.

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What is GitHub Copilot CLI?

GitHub Copilot CLI brings AI assistance directly to your command line. It is an AI assistant for the terminal that can plan and execute multistep tasks, search documentation, edit files, and connect to external data sources; all through natural language conversations.

For Microsoft Partners, Copilot CLI becomes especially powerful when connected to the Microsoft Learn MCP Server, giving you instant, grounded answers from official Microsoft documentation. No browser tab switching required.

Key capabilities

Capability	What it means for you
Natural language interface	Ask questions in plain English; no syntax to memorize.
MCP extensibility	Connect to Microsoft Learn for real-time, trusted docs.
GitHub integration	Access repos, issues, and PRs natively.
Multi-step task execution	Copilot can plan and carry out complex workflows for you.
Full control	Preview every action before it runs; nothing happens without your approval.

01 Getting Started

Prerequisites

- An active GitHub Copilot [subscription](#).
- Windows: PowerShell v6 or higher.
- macOS / Linux: any modern terminal.

Install Copilot CLI

Choose the method that fits your platform:

Windows (recommended)

```
winget install GitHub.Copilot
```

macOS / Linux

```
brew install copilot-cli
```

Cross-platform (npm)

```
npm install -g @github/copilot
```

macOS / Linux (curl)

```
curl -fsSL https://gh.io/copilot-install | bash
```

Launch & sign in

```
copilot
```

On first launch, follow the on-screen prompts to authenticate with your GitHub account. If prompted, use the `/login` command.

TIP

Premium requests are metered.

Each prompt you send uses one premium request from your monthly quota. Use `/context` to monitor token usage.

02 Connecting the Microsoft Learn MCP Server

The Microsoft Learn MCP Server streams official documentation from learn.microsoft.com directly into your Copilot CLI session. It's free, requires no authentication, and uses the Streamable HTTP protocol.

Add the MCP Server (recommended)

In Copilot CLI, run:

```
/mcp add microsoft-learn
```

When prompted, enter the following:

- Server Type: 3 (HTTP)
- URL: <https://learn.microsoft.com/api/mcp>
- HTTP Headers: (leave empty, press Enter)
- Tools: *

Verify the connection

```
/mcp show
```

You should see microsoft-learn listed with a connected status and its tools available.

Alternative: plugin install

You can also use the plugin system (`/plugin install microsoftdocs/mcp`)

NOTE

About the Learn MCP endpoint.

The Learn MCP endpoint (<https://learn.microsoft.com/api/mcp>) is designed for programmatic access by MCP clients. It will return a 405 Method Not Allowed if you open it in a browser. This is expected behavior, not an error.

03 Try Your First Prompts

Before diving into licensing specifics, spend a few minutes getting comfortable with how Copilot CLI responds. These general prompts exercise the Learn MCP connection and show off Copilot's range; multi-step planning, documentation search, and grounded citations; without locking you into a narrow scenario.

Warm-up prompts

Copy and paste these into Copilot CLI to see how answers arrive, how citations are formatted, and how long responses take:

Capabilities overview

```
What can you help me with? Summarize your capabilities and show a couple of example prompts.
```

Microsoft 365 at a glance

```
Give me a one-page overview of the main Microsoft 365 services; what each one does and who typically uses it. Cite Microsoft Learn sources.
```

Purview at a high level

```
Explain Microsoft Purview in plain English. What problems does it solve and which products sit under the Purview umbrella?
```

Copilot for Microsoft 365 deployment

```
Find and summarize the recommended deployment steps for Copilot for Microsoft 365 in a mid-sized tenant. Link to the Microsoft Learn articles you used.
```

Multi-step task

```
Draft a short customer-facing FAQ (5 questions) about adopting Microsoft 365 Copilot. Use Microsoft Learn as your source and note any licensing caveats.
```

TIP

What to look for.

Grounded answers always cite learn.microsoft.com links. If you don't see citations, ask Copilot to include them; and cross-check any surprising claims before sharing with a customer.

04 Answering M365 Licensing Questions

Once the Learn MCP Server is connected, Copilot CLI can pull answers directly from official Microsoft documentation. This is ideal for fielding licensing questions from SMB customers; the Business family (Basic, Standard, Premium) is your default frame, with E3 and E5 as the "what comes next" horizon when customers outgrow Business Premium.

How it works

```
You ask a question
  → Copilot queries the Learn MCP Server
    → Server searches learn.microsoft.com
      → You get a grounded, cited answer
```

Reference materials

Bookmark these for reference:

Resource	URL	Use for
M365 Maps	m365maps.com	Visual license comparison diagrams
Feature Matrix	m365maps.com/matrix.htm	Detailed feature-by-plan grid
Microsoft Licensing Docs	learn.microsoft.com/microsoft-365	Official SKU and licensing documentation

NOTE

Third-party resources.

M365 Maps is a community-maintained reference based on public Microsoft resources.

Suggested prompts; licensing

Copy and paste these directly into Copilot CLI:

Business plan comparison

```
Compare Microsoft 365 Business Basic, Business Standard, and Business Premium. Which is best for a 50-user SMB, and what are the biggest differences?
```

Copilot with Business SKUs

```
A customer has Microsoft 365 Business Standard and wants to add Copilot for Microsoft 365. What are the licensing prerequisites and upgrade paths?
```

Business Premium security & compliance baseline

```
What security and compliance features are included in Microsoft 365 Business Premium? How does it compare to Business Standard, and where does it stop short of E5?
```

When to outgrow Business Premium

```
What are the signals that an SMB customer has outgrown Microsoft 365 Business Premium? When should I propose moving them to E3 or E5?
```

Defender for Business vs Defender for Endpoint

```
Does Business Premium include Defender for Business and Intune? How do these differ from Defender for Endpoint P1 / P2 in E3 and E5?
```

Add-ons on top of Business Premium

```
Which Microsoft 365 add-ons can pair with Business Premium to unlock E5-level compliance features (auto-labeling, Insider Risk, eDiscovery Premium) without moving the whole customer to full E5?
```

TIP

Pro tip; more reliable answers.

Add this to any licensing prompt: "Use only Microsoft Learn sources, cite documentation links, and call out any licensing caveats or assumptions."

05 MIP & Purview; Going Deeper

Microsoft Information Protection (MIP) and Microsoft Purview are MVP focus areas for this guide. For SMB partners, the most common question is: "What comes with Business Premium today, and when does my customer need to move to E5 or add E5 Compliance?" The matrix below maps the key Purview features to the SKUs you'll quote most often.

Sensitivity labels; licensing at a glance

Feature	Business Standard	Business Premium	E5 / E5 Compliance*
Manual sensitivity labeling	No	Yes	Yes
Auto sensitivity labeling (content-based)	No	No	Yes
Core DLP (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive)	No	Yes	Yes
Endpoint DLP & Teams DLP	No	No	Yes
Insider Risk Management	No	No	Yes
eDiscovery Premium	No	No	Yes
Advanced Audit (long-term retention)	No	No	Yes
Information Barriers	No	No	Yes
Communication Compliance	No	No	Yes
Records Management	No	No	Yes
Trainable Classifiers	No	No	Yes
Double Key Encryption	No	No	Yes
Exact Data Match (EDM)	No	No	Yes

NOTE**Add-on paths.**

Add-on paths include E5 Compliance, E5 Information Protection & Governance, or a full Microsoft 365 E5 upgrade. Each unlocks different feature subsets. Always verify the exact add-on required for each feature against official Microsoft licensing documentation.

Suggested prompts; MIP & Purview for SMB

1. Does Microsoft 365 Business Premium include sensitivity labels? What labeling features are only available with E5 or the E5 Compliance add-on?
2. My SMB customer has a Business Premium and wants automatic sensitivity labeling. What add-on or upgrade is required?
3. Compare Data Loss Prevention capabilities in Business Standard, Business Premium, and E5. Which DLP scenarios (endpoint, Teams, Exchange, SharePoint) need E5 or an add-on?
4. A Business Premium customer needs Insider Risk Management. What's the cleanest licensing path; move to E5, add E5 Compliance, or something else?
5. What Microsoft Purview compliance features come with Business Premium out of the box, and which ones require an upgrade?
6. A customer is weighing Business Premium vs jumping to E3 + E5 Compliance. What compliance capabilities does each option unlock?
7. What are the licensing requirements for Microsoft Purview eDiscovery Standard vs Premium? Is eDiscovery available on Business SKUs?
8. What's the difference between Microsoft Purview Information Protection and Data Loss Prevention? How do they work together for an SMB customer?
9. An SMB customer needs to protect sensitive data in Teams chats and meetings. What licenses and Purview features do they need, starting from Business Premium?
10. When a customer asks, "do I need E5?", which compliance triggers should I look for to recommend E5 or E5 Compliance add-on over staying on Business Premium?

06 Validate Your Answers

Copilot CLI is a powerful research accelerator, but licensing guidance should always be verified before sharing with customers.

Recommended workflow

- **Ask;** Use Copilot CLI with the Learn MCP Server.
- **Check citations;** Open the Microsoft Learn links Copilot provides.
- **Cross-reference;** Compare against M365 Maps / Feature Matrix.
- **Confirm;** Validate with Product Terms or your Microsoft Account team for final guidance.

What Copilot CLI is not for

NOT FOR

Three scenarios where Copilot CLI should not be the source of truth

- **Pricing / quoting;** Prices vary by region, agreement type, CSP/NCE, and promos. Use Partner Center or your account team.
- **Tenant-specific validation;** Copilot CLI doesn't inspect a customer's actual tenant or licenses.
- **Contractual advice;** Always refer to official Product Terms for binding license definitions.

07 Tips & Tricks

Quick Start Checklist

- ☐ Install Copilot CLI `winget install GitHub.Copilot`
- ☐ Launch and sign in copilot → `/login`
- ☐ Connect Microsoft Learn MCP `/mcp add microsoft-learn`
- ☐ Verify connection `/mcp show`
- ☐ Try your first licensing prompt.

Commands

Command / Syntax	What it does
<code>/model</code>	Switch between AI models (Claude Sonnet, GPT-5, etc.)
<code>/compact</code>	Compress conversation history to free up the context window.
<code>/context</code>	Show detailed token usage breakdown.
<code>/plugin</code>	Install, list, or manage plugins (e.g. microsoftdocs/mcp).
<code>/mcp show</code>	Check status and tools for all connected MCP servers.
<code>/research</code>	Deep research for complex multi-source questions.
<code>/share</code>	Export session markdown, HTML, or GitHub Gist.
<code>/experimental</code>	Enable experimental features (persisted across sessions).
<code>@filename</code>	Mention a specific file to include as context.
<code>#42</code>	Reference to a GitHub issue or PR by number.

Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Shift + Tab	Cycle between interaction modes (ask/execute ↔ plan)
Ctrl + S	Run and keep input
Ctrl + C	Cancel current operation
Ctrl + L	Clear screen
Esc	Reject a tool request and give inline feedback

08 Reference Links

Resource	Link
GitHub Copilot CLI Documentation	docs.github.com/en/copilot/concepts/agents/copilot-cli/about-copilot-cli
Copilot CLI ; Adding MCP Servers	docs.github.com/en/copilot/how-tos/copilot-cli/customize-copilot/add-mcp-servers
Microsoft Learn MCP Server	github.com/MicrosoftDocs/mcp
M365 Maps (License Diagrams)	m365maps.com
Feature Matrix	m365maps.com/matrix.htm
Microsoft 365 Licensing Docs	learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365
Microsoft Purview Compliance	learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview
Copilot Plans & Pricing	github.com/features/copilot/plans
Microsoft Learn MCP Overview	learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/support/mcp
Microsoft Learn MCP; Get Started	learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/support/mcp-get-started

